

Mathew 24

Contested miracles

In this sermon I will be drawing the distinctions between the true and fake (false) miracles being witnessed in many churches and associated with many proclaimed ministers of the living gospel. This contest is so much about God's miracle working through His chosen servants and the use of satanic powers in fake miracles in deception of thousands and millions of desperate and ignorant church goers. In this sermon, the word fake is not used to mean non-occurrence but rather an alternative power other than that we are given by Jesus

The above last sentence means that one may perform a true miracle and it is steal fake. That is, it is not founded on the Spirit of truth, The Holy Spirit. Just like false prophets may prophesy true events that come to pass, they can also do real and true miracles but this doesn't take away the fact that they are false and against Jesus. **Matthew 7:22 -23** Jesus talking about the fate of false prophets at the judgement day says that many will cry to Him and tell of how they used to give prophecies and drive out demons in His name, but the Lord will tell them to go away for they belonged not to Him

Everyone knows themselves very well. Even the false ministers knows who they are and why. In **Matthew 7:22-23** they are trying even deceive Jesus that they used to do it in His name and for His glory and by the deception get a short-cut to paradise of Heaven just they did with the paradise of the world. They use these miracles, signs and wonders as a shortcut to earthly riches and fame

The question as to whom do you know or think to be a false prophet is actually a difficult one for many people and this is how it ought to be. The Bible advises us that we should not judge over others in **Matthew 7:2-3**. The scripture reminds us that no one is perfect and again, judgement belongs to Him who is righteous.

The reason why teachings on false prophets is so important to believers is because of its characteristic ability to deceive masses including the truly anointed of the Lord and move them from the way of truth making them to start doubting their faith and relationship with God. This is what Jesus taught in **Mathew 24:11 and 24**

When Jesus Christ first taught on this subject to His disciples, everyone received the message with a lot of concern and an immediate need to understand more arose among them. They asked Jesus if He could tell them how the false prophets will look like and what time they will arise. Obviously this is the ordinary first step for humans to deal with a challenging situation. That is, having all possible accurate facts about it. Do you remember what Moses did in **Numbers 13** and Joshua in **Joshua 2?** They wanted to know who lived in Canaan, what they do, how many they were, how structured they were etc. we call this *intelligence* in our political governments.

This knowledge is equally important for you and I. if we do not have accurately true knowledge about false prophets and false miracles, signs and wonders makes us vulnerable to their trickeries and deception. Before you realize who they have been and really are, you are physically, spiritually and emotionally robbed!!

The Bible puts it clear that God's people perish for the lack of knowledge (**Hoses 4:6**). What the Bible calls knowledge or wisdom is **the truth hidden in the spirit**. For instance, failure to know it is by what spirit a person is prophesying or casting out demonic spirits and them running to bow before them for anointing thinking that they are the anointed servants of the Most High God. I once thought of visiting a prominent church where miracles are claimed to be the order of everyday but the Spirit of God appeared to me in dream and warned me against going to honour the servant in that church and I obliged to the counsel of the Spirit of God

So therefore, the knowledge and wisdom Hosea talks about here are the revelation of what is hidden in the spirit and the ability to differentiate between false and truth. God is willing to make you know about them no matter how much they may do to hide their identity because the Spirit of God is hidden of nothing (**1Corinthians 2:10**).

The time Jesus was referring to is no doubt the days we are living in today where Christian worship centres are the most controversial places with fake miracles said to have happen. Miracles of healing, financial promotions, resurrection, evil spirit exhortation and many more

I have heard several people saying that they have chosen to remain at home on Sundays than going to church. Some explain how the church has scooped money from them leaving them poorer to how they lost

their couples in separations orchestrated by the church and misleading doctrines.

There is no doubt a true prophet of God MUST portray basic character of our Lord Jesus Christ who stands at the centre of Christian faith. We may not be like Jesus (for Jesus is God and perfectly blameless) but portraying some of His basic character (which I am highlighting later in this article) is a must. Jesus told them not the names of the false prophets who were there or who were to come later in years, but he told them about their character expressed in their actions and outcome, (fruits). Character determines your action and utterance. Then action and utterance gives birth to the fruits of a person

Now let us go straight to the first miracle of Jesus Christ recorded in **John 2:7-10**. Here, the men were in short of alcohol and it was too early in the hours of the ceremony. There was no possible way additional wine could be prepared and made ready the soonest it was required to hype the marriage ceremony. Mary, the mother of Jesus approached her son (Jesus) and told Him that the men had finished the available wine and they wanted more. Then Jesus decided to make available miraculous wine. He called the young stewards and asked them to fill the available jars with water. When they did as He had told them and returned to inform that all jars were already full, Jesus told them to get some from the jars and take it to the men and let them taste and Loh!, it was already wine, better than the one which had been made by men.

There was no special water used in this miracle. The people filled in the jars with the same water which was being used in cooking, washing, drinking and all other activities needing water at the party. This teaches the following about God's miracle:

1. God's miracle is not meant to look very special in the first place (although they really are). No one, including the stewards who filled the Jars with water could have attached any special value to the water except the ordinary value they knew of before the miracle.
2. God's miracle will always happen in His own hour and not when you are expecting it. When Mary approached Jesus and informed Him of the shortage of wine, Jesus said "**My hour has not yet come**". Mary went away but left a word to the stewards telling them "**whatever He tells you to do, please do**". Today we are told to go to the church expecting

a miracle. While it is a good thing to say and hope for, but the funny part of it is the surety the leader of the church has that tomorrow there shall surely be a miracle. It turns out to be sinful if it is only for the miracle that you wake up on a Sunday morning or any other day and hurry up for a church service. We ought to attend church services to worship God and meet up with brethren for a common prayer and testimonies. And when we attend we know that can happen in the presence of God. Jesus speaking to the young men who came to Him asking for a miracle and a sign in **Mathew 12:39 and 16:4**, told them that they represented a wicked and adulterous generation. Could we be having this generation flocking places of worship every single Sunday and other days of church service?

3. True miracles of God should cost you no money whatsoever. The people at Cana paid nothing directly or indirectly for the miracle of wine. Jesus did not order them for some special water that would probably have cost them money and more time. Instead, the Lord used the locally available water for the miracle. This cost probably would have become the one single barrier to their miracle on the day and hour of God. How many people are missing out on their miracle today in our churches (assuming that the miracles are a true one) simply because they could not afford the price for that magic handkerchief, magic oil, magic water, magic sticker extra. I am calling **magic** that which is referred to as **anointing** in the false miracles. They simply use the word anointing to win unsuspecting followers seeking miracles. Even Satan was seen arising from the sea wearing the clothes that looked like the ones of the lamb but it was known to be him when he started to talk for he blasphemed against God
4. The doer of true miracles (who is God) has no business going around telling everyone about it (whether prior to or even after the miracle). The people healed or set free in the miracle will go around telling of the extraordinary encounter. At Cana Jesus did not call to the attention of everyone to announce the miracle which was about to happen. Either He did not go around asking people of how much they loved the new wine and hence tell them that He had made it for them. It is the stewards who struggled around telling people what had happened. When Jesus drove out evil spirits from the man who had lived in the

grave yards for many years in Mark 5 and the man was set free, Jesus turned down his request to accompany Jesus wherever He went. When He healed the blind man in the streets of Jericho, Jesus told him to go and show himself to the chief priests and offer there. Jesus may have done for two possible reasons; one, for God to take all the glory for what He (God) has done and two, there was no direct way He is to benefit from the miracle. In our churches it is completely the opposite. People are called to attend services so they may give their testimonies. Our Pastors are obviously the ones associated with the miracle and not God. Miracles are sold out for money. It is now give money and receive your miracle. Doing of miracles appears to have become a spiritually manufactured product that incur cost and that must be offered for a price. The profit goes back to the Pastor and they have made a huge catch on it!

From Cana let us look at other subsequent miracle by Jesus and also old testament prophets and see how they compare to the miracles we are seen the with many modern churches

In **John 9:6-7** Jesus healed a man born blind. The Lord wanted to use a medium to transfer power of healing to the man. He turned around and spit some of His saliva and mixed it with soil to make a sticky mud which he applied on the eyes of the blind man and told him to go to a nearby pool and wash his face. As the clay got washed away from the eyes so also did the power of blindness and the man could see for the first ever time. The soil and the saliva cost nothing. People giving you fake miracles will make sure they use materials that must appear specially manufactured and not local.

During this encounter, the disciples asked Jesus why was the man born blind (**verse 2-3**). Jesus replied by saying that no one had sinned for the many to be born blind. Jesus was simply avoiding causing unnecessary anxiety, fear and panic in the man and making him to feel sinful and inferior. A false prophet would have used minutes to explain to the man terrifying reasons for his blindness. They use this as a tool of intimidation, causing fear and panic to the victim. When a person is put under the control of fear and panic he becomes vulnerable to manipulation and theft. You will sell anything to offer and procure freedom which will never come. Fear, panic and intimidation are weapons used by Satan against God's people and those who use it

serve him. Jesus never caused us fear, panic nor causes us anxiety when we need a miracle and true prophets will never do it

In **Matthew 14:16-21** (Jesus feeding 5000 people with 5 loafs of bread and 2 fish), Jesus did this miracle using what was locally and conveniently available. He did not have to bother the people to go looking for anything else special in any way. Either He did not call the attention of everyone to watch out as He multiplied the loaves and fishes. Only the disciples knew that they were not enough food and that He was multiplying it. The rest were ordered to sit down and wait to be served. The same He repeated in **Matthew 15:32-39** where even the disciples suggested they should run to the shops and buy more food. Jesus still made sure that there was no cost for a miracle

When Jesus visited Peter at the lake where together with his friends had fished overnight to catch nothing (**Luke 5:4-10**), He did them a miracle using their very own nets and in the same lake they had spent painful night. If it was these prophets of today they would have been ordered to acquire special nets or given magic oil to apply before lowering their nets into the waters next time. Jesus did not even ask to touch their nets! He made it simple, clear and inexpensive. Anointing oil, handkerchiefs, water, and magic ring given to you by false prophets for you to carry with them have made you a slave of what is man-made.

All the above illustrations and many more that we cannot narrate here because of limited space shows the character of the Spirit of God in miracles. In all the miracles our Lord Jesus ever did there is stability of character. True prophets must copy the character of Jesus to whom they are called and serve. Jesus said that a bad tree bears bad fruits and a good tree bears good fruits. He also said that the things that the son does are the things the son has seen His father do. Hence, true prophets will always copy Jesus in teachings and in Miracles since we are born of Him. Those who do not portray the character of Jesus Christ are against Jesus and effectively serves Satan

Let us briefly look at the character of the Biblical prophets all whom we believe performed great miracles and shown great signs and wonders in the Spirit of God. We will see if truly they portrayed the character similar to that of Jesus Christ

We begin with Moses and the miracle of snake in **Exodus 4:2**. In the first instance God asked Moses what he was holding in his hand and

Moses replied, “a stick”. Then God said to him, drop it to the ground and when Moses did, he realized it was a huge snake. God said to him, “you shall do this before Pharaoh”. Now God wanted to perform a sign and win the believe of Moses in Him. It was simple, clear and inexpensive. The stick Moses was holding had nothing significant. He had made it for use as he looked after the sheep of his father in –law. He would later perform many other big miracles (including dividing the Red sea using the same stick.

In [2Kings 4:3-7](#) is the miracle by prophet Elisha of Olive oil for the widow. He asked her “what do you have in your house?” and she said she only had a small jar of Olive Oil. He told her to borrow from neighbours additional Jars as she could. He asked God to show the woman mercy and all jars were filled with Olive Oil. She paid no money or price and nothing special was used for this miracle. The prophet did not call the neighbours to come and witness the miracle.

Also see in [2Kings 2:19-22](#) where the same prophet cured the water of the city using the same water and salts from the kitchen of a local resident. The prophet only asked them to put water in a new bowel and it wasn’t special in any other way. The Prophet of God was not in a business of selling bowels of any kind hence, he did not sell it to the locals so that he may benefit in anyway as they received their miracle. After the miracle and the land and its waters were healed, Prophet Elisha left the town leaving the locals to freely enjoy the working of the Lord ([Verse 23](#)).

Now let us look at the deeds of the disciples of Jesus who turned to be early apostles. Did they copy their Master Jesus Christ as they moved around the world doing great miracles and showing great wonders and signs by the power inherited to them by Jesus?

We start with Apostle Paul in [Acts 19:11-12](#) in Ephesus. The scripture points out something very clear “**God did many extraordinary miracles through Paul**”. It is clear again from this scripture that it is always God doing miracles and never the person. All credits must go back to God and His Holy name must be at the centre of a true miracle. True servants of God understand this and intentionally must express it. They would never chest thumb but allow God to take all the glory. They prefer that their name is forgotten immediately and the name of God surfaces or comes at the surface because He is the doer of the miracle. The apostles were not so much obsessed with the gospel of miracles, wonders and signs. They spent most of their ministry time preaching

the ultimate message of salvation and baptism through Jesus Christ. They taught people so that they may understand the Kingdom of Heaven (the kingdom of God) which is the kingdom of true miracles, signs and wonders.

It is sad that today the gospel of miracles, signs and wonders has overtaken the gospel of salvation, repentance and baptism. Miracles are being used as bate to attract huge congregation for selfish gains of men and women self-proclaimed prophets of God. it wouldn’t be a bad idea if when people are attracted by the same then we took advantage of it to tell them that the miracles they are seeking isn’t as important as knowing and accepting Jesus (who is the Truth) and by whom all people can be set free and experience true miracles with Godly purpose.

Even Jesus one time refused to show a sign or do a miracle for perceiving the people to be more obsessed with miracles and signs than the kingdom that shows such miracles and sins, the kingdom of God ([Mathew 12:38-39](#)). In another incident Jesus told the people that He knew they had come to Him not because of the desire to learn about the kingdom of God but for the miracle of bread ([John 6:22-26](#)). On this day Jesus said there was not going to be a miracle of bread but He was going to teach about the kingdom of heaven. Many people abandoned Him and went away on hearing what Jesus said. This is why Jesus said in the previous verse that, the people are only interested in the miracles and not the kingdom is part of an adulterous generation.

Many false prophets are learned the fact that, majority of people of this world are only interested in miracles, signs and wonders and have nothing to do with the mother kingdom. They have therefore schemed ways and methods of serving the interests of the people and not of Jesus Christ but still they do so while holding in their hands the Bible and inside the temple (church). Jesus was worry of the fact that many lovers of miracles and not the kingdom of God would largely fall victims of false prophets and this is what is happening right today

In the case of [Acts 19:11-12](#), people brought their own clothes , handkerchiefs and touched Paul with it or asked him to place his hand on them and hurried with them back home. They lay upon the sick and they got healed by the anointing on the material. It is good to differentiate what Paul did with what you see today. Paul did not stock any of such clothes for issuing to the needy. He did not pioneer the entire thing but by faith those who believed in his God given anointing and who had difficulties in having a one-on one encounter with the

Apostle did. Paul charged nothing for this anointing and did not order them for any special clothing. God will always give you a miracle with what you conveniently have and He does not look for money or fame. Paul did not send people around the city to tell others of what he was doing even after learning of the amazing way God was using

When Jesus was commissioning the disciples to go al places around the world preaching the good news and baptizing people in the name of the Father, the Son and The Holy Spirit, He said to them “freely you have received and freely you will give”. Jesus was talking about the grace of anointing received from Him and the same way it should be given.

In [John 17:5 and 22, verse 5](#), “..and now Father , glorify me in your presence with the glory I had with you before the world began”. **Verse 22, ..**“I have given them the glory that you gave me that they may be one as we are one”. Jesus received the glory for free and He passes it to His servants for free. Those who labour truly for Him Must give it for no charge.

And assigning them the work of His ministry, He strictly charged them to go manifesting the glory of God free of charge to all Nations of the world. He particularly told them, as “as you go to the nations tell them this message that the kingdom of heaven has come near. Heal the sick, raise the dead and cleanse those who have leprosy, drive out demons. Freely you have received this glory and freely you shall give it to those who need it” ([Mathew 10:7-8](#))

I heard one Pastor teaching young and emerging servants of the kingdom of God and he said to them, in fact quoting from the Bible that for them to succeed in gospel they needed the power of the pocket (money). I feel this statement is false in principle. Jesus knowing that false prophets will arise and mislead the world made it clear that this gospel does not need the power of money to succeed ([Mathew 10:9-10](#)). He indicated that, God, the author and owner of the gospel and ministry will always provide the means and the way. In another occasion as He prepared the disciples for the eventual ministry He said to them, do not love money and the things of the world for if you did so then the love for God is not their” ([1John 2:15](#)). At the centre of false prophets is **money** and **material wealth**. This is the reason anointing oil is sols, anointing water is sold, handkerchiefs are sold, wall calendars are sold. They tell you that their image printed on the miracle

card, calendars and other church publications will defend you against witchcraft, sorcerers, demonic spiritual attacks and bad omen.

Jesus is God and is not separated from His word for the word is God. He objected mixing of money , material things and gospel and in **John 2:14-16 and Mathew 21:12-13** He chased from the temple people who were selling and buying telling them that they were thugs and thieves who had hijacked the house of His Father. Simply put, Jesus is not happy that it continues to happen even to date. But God has set time and seasons for everything and at the right time Jesus will chase them away from near the Kingdom of His father. Jesus says (in respect to judgement), not all that preach or teach in His name truly further the agenda He set for the church. Some are out to enriching themselves and achieving self-interests. He will say to them, **“go away, I do not know you”**

I humbly advise you to be on the watch out that you are not drained of resources and black folded with fake miracles, held hostage, manipulated and thrown away when your taste is not there anymore. Thank you for reading this article. May it bring light and drive out darkness in you and your surrounding in Jesus name. Amen

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